

D234. Meaning and Consciousness Framework

Integration Register

Formal integration of D233 into the Base Model v1.6C framework

Document status: Framework integration register - conceptual layer, not empirical proof

Core integration sentence: Meaning is the world becoming consequential inside a living boundary.
Consciousness is the boundary becoming wide enough to know that it is being changed.

1. Purpose

This register formally links D233, Meaning, Consciousness, and Embodied Relevance Theory, into the framework architecture. D233 is treated as a conceptual and philosophical integration layer that clarifies what the empirical PR-AYC-G, Decoder-Gate, Autonomic Presence, Cognitive Zeno-Lock, and Frequency Cascade layers are attempting to measure indirectly.

Boundary: D233 does not define consciousness by fiat, prove consciousness physiologically, or convert self-report into ground truth. It defines a disciplined conceptual grammar for meaning, organism-state displacement, and conscious integration.

2. Canonical definitions integrated

$$M_i(S) = || \ x_i(t + \Delta t) - x_i(t) \ ||_W$$

Meaning for organism i is defined as relevance-weighted organism-state displacement produced by stimulus or event S. The weighting matrix W encodes biological, autobiographical, relational, and action-relevant importance.

$$x_i(t) = [Belief_i, Body_i, Memory_i, Self_i, Relation_i, Policy_i, Future_i]$$

This vector is not a direct measurement. It is a conceptual/model-state object whose components require separate operational proxies.

Consciousness $\sim$ integrative bandwidth for binding sensation, body, memory, self, other, and future into an updateable field

The symbol $\sim$ is intentional. The framework treats this as a philosophical and model-level thesis, not a solved empirical identity claim.

3. Layer placement

Framework layer	Role of D233	Measurement status	Permitted claim
Conceptual/philosophical layer	Defines meaning as relevance-weighted state displacement.	Model-derived	Clarifies ontology of meaning without proving consciousness.
Neurophenomenology	Links first-person meaning, absorption, afterglow, and fragmentation to physiological hypotheses.	Self-report + coding	Reports constrain models but do not replace physiology.
PR-AYC-G	Defines what target, scrambled, and override arms manipulate: signal structure, receiver stance, and meaning access.	Empirical protocol bridge	Meaning may leave autonomic, spectral, and recovery traces.

Autonomic Presence	Interprets API_A as bodily readiness for meaning access without defensive acceleration.	Derived from HR/RMSSD/SDNN/slope	API_A estimates regulated availability, not consciousness.
Memory refresh	Connects durable meaning to attractor displacement and reactivation rather than permanent identical substrate.	Longitudinal/model-derived	Durable meaning is the surviving portion of acute update.

4. Updated relation to PR-AYC-G

$S_PRAYCG, v1.6C(t) = [API_A, P_gamma, PLV_gamma, PNCC_theta, Z_lock, G_resp, MeaningReport, Artifact]$

D233 provides the conceptual interpretation of this state vector. The vector does not measure meaning directly; it organizes candidate traces of meaning access across body, EEG, task state, respiration, and first-person report.

PR-AYC-G element	D233 interpretation
Phase-scrambled control	Signal energy remains, decodable narrative meaning is removed.
Target 1	Structured signal meets a receptive gate; organism-state displacement should be possible.
Contextual override	Structured signal remains, but receiver stance shifts toward analytic measurement and partitioning.
Washout	The return path where acute meaning becomes after-state, integration, or dissipation.
Self-report	Independent phenomenological stream estimating meaning, absorption, afterglow, and fragmentation.

5. Expected dissociations

- High reported meaning with low API_A may indicate activating meaning, distress, effort, fatigue, or unmodeled pathway rather than regulated presence.
- High low-gamma power with low self-reported meaning may indicate artifact, task load, visual attention, or non-affective local processing.
- High PNCC_theta with low target meaning may indicate narrative continuity, rumination, or inadequate washout rather than empathy.
- High physiological coherence with low reported presence may indicate relaxation, compliance, boredom, or construct mismatch.
- High self-reported meaning with no physiological trace does not falsify experience; it constrains the specific physiological hypothesis.

6. Falsifiable bridge claims

- Meaning reports should predict at least some PR-AYC-G endpoints beyond valence/arousal alone if D233 maps onto the empirical layers.
- Meaning-induced state displacement should be stronger for intact target than phase-scrambled control under matched sensory energy.
- Durable meaning should show at least partial persistence in delayed recall, re-exposure response, or baseline/regulatory state, not only immediate intensity.
- If demand, familiarity, mood, and artifact fully explain self-report and physiological endpoints, the D233 bridge is constrained.

7. Non-claims

- D233 does not prove consciousness.

- D233 does not make self-report infallible.
- D233 does not claim meaning is identical to low-gamma power, theta carryover, HRV, or any single endpoint.
- D233 does not assert a literal universal wave-function mechanism for human narrative response.
- D233 does not provide clinical advice, diagnosis, therapy, or metaphysical doctrine.